

Chapter 46-4

Liang Shi only wanted to know whether that was a dream or reality.

Now Qi Jiao's reaction proved everything.

Next, it would be a matter between her and Qiu Zimin.

However, as fellow victims, Liang Shi still wanted to encourage Qi Jiao. "If parents become demons, then they don't deserve to be called parents. You don't have to keep enduring - that will only make the demons become even more brazen."

Qi Jiao looked at her, her brows slightly furrowed, as if deep in thought.

"Also," Liang Shi said, "when you're in love with Cheng Ran, keep some reservations. Don't love too completely."

People who have been abused easily fall into love, but often end up being hurt beyond recognition by love again.

Qi Jiao didn't answer her words.

After a long while, she asked, "Do you really think you've successfully escaped?"

Liang Shi smiled, "Not yet, but someday I will succeed, right?"

Her hopeful gaze struck Qi Jiao's heart like a heavy blow.

"The first step of resistance is strengthening your inner self," Liang Shi said. "She might not be able to beat you now."

"I'm working my way out. Perhaps, you can watch me. If one day I need someone to testify in court, I hope you can come, because this isn't just my matter - this is something we experienced together."

Liang Shi's voice was gentle, deliberately lowered to a warm and lingering tone. Although it was autumn, it made people feel like spring breeze was blowing, carrying hints of spring vitality and vigor.

As if what she said was real, achievable.

"Of course, I'm not morally blackmailing you," Liang Shi said. "You can be afraid, you can retreat - these are all understandable. But I hope you can be brave."

Qi Jiao's tears fell with the wind.

Liang Shi said, "Let's be brave together."

Under her highly persuasive tone and rhetoric, Qi Jiao suddenly smiled. That smile was like a withered flower at the end of autumn, carrying hints of decay and desolation. "But what if I said that Qi Jiao has already..."

The words stopped abruptly halfway through.

That half sentence "died" got stuck in her throat.

Liang Shi asked gently, "What?"

Reason returned.

Qi Jiao raised her hand to wipe away her tears, "Nothing."

She took a deep breath and once again erected high walls, shutting Liang Shi out. "I'll pretend I never heard what you said. You should go."

Liang Shi didn't press further either.

Whether it was her own experience or the original owner's experience, both made her feel fear the moment she remembered, the moment she saw Mrs. Qi.

Qi Jiao had always lived in such an environment - how could she possibly not be afraid?

She understood Qi Jiao's cowardice and respected her choice.

Liang Shi just hoped she could find her way out.

Could be a little braver.

Say no to domestic violence.

"Teacher Qi," Liang Shi said, "I'm sorry for making you recall some unpleasant memories, but I don't regret today's conversation. I hope you can think about it carefully too."

"The little girl has grown up. We can protect others, but the first person we should protect is ourselves."

At this moment, Liang Shi's tone was more like a kindergarten teacher than Qi Jiao's.

Coaxing and cajoling.

It had to be said, this was still effective.

Qi Jiao fell into contemplation.

As she said goodbye to Qi Jiao and turned to leave, Qi Jiao suddenly called out to her, "Miss Liang."

Liang Shi turned around, her smile gentle, more fervent than the fire clouds on the evening horizon. "Mm?"

"Su Yu's mother isn't called Su Yao," Qi Jiao brought up another matter. "Her mother is called Su Mu, from a single-parent family."

Footnotes:

¹ Worldview (世界觀): One's fundamental beliefs about the nature of reality, values, and how the world works.